

Civilization FT-AI and Function Tunnel Evolution Cybernetics

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with chatGPT (OpenAI)

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Repository: <https://github.com/sizhet/Function-Tunnel-AI>

Abstract

Function Tunnel AI (FT-AI) has been introduced as a framework for understanding, detecting, measuring, and governing Function Tunnels (FTs) across engineering systems, education, economies, and societies.

One common criticism is that civilization-scale Function Tunnels evolve over decades or centuries, making them seemingly impossible to validate or control.

This article argues that such criticism arises from an incorrect assumption: that long-term Function Tunnels can only be evaluated through their final outcomes.

Historical evidence suggests otherwise.

Large-scale civilizations, institutions, infrastructures, educational systems, and technological ecosystems have always relied on continuous planning, monitoring, feedback, and correction mechanisms.

The formation process of a Function Tunnel is itself observable, measurable, and governable.

This observation leads to a new perspective:

Civilization FT-AI may emerge not as a long-range prediction engine, but as a cybernetic system for monitoring and governing Function Tunnel evolution.

1. The Misconception of Civilization-Scale Evolution

When discussing civilization-scale transformations, people often imagine a process like:

Policy

↓

Several Decades

↓

Final Outcome

Under this view, success or failure can only be evaluated after the entire process has completed.

This assumption creates an apparent challenge:

If Function Tunnels evolve over decades or centuries, how can FT-AI ever receive useful feedback?

The answer is that civilization evolution rarely operates this way.

Real-world transformations are almost always decomposed into stages.

Vision



Phase 1



Phase 2



Phase 3



Phase N

Each stage produces measurable outcomes, costs, risks, and structural changes.

Therefore civilization evolution is not a single delayed feedback loop.

It is a hierarchy of continuous feedback loops.

2. Civilization History as Function Tunnel Construction

Many of humanity's most significant achievements can be viewed as Function Tunnel construction processes.

Examples include:

- Agricultural civilization
- Industrialization
- National education systems
- Scientific institutions
- Transportation infrastructures
- Electrical grids
- The Internet
- Global supply chains

- Open-source ecosystems

These developments were not random historical accidents.

They were long-term attempts to establish stable pathways through which knowledge, resources, skills, and coordination could repeatedly flow.

In FT terminology:

Civilization Progress

=

Function Tunnel Construction

Human history can therefore be interpreted as a massive collection of Function Tunnel evolution experiments.

3. Existing Civilization Practices Already Use FT Control

Large engineering projects and public policies are rarely executed blindly.

Instead they usually involve:

Planning

Monitoring

Risk Management

Budget Control

Milestone Evaluation

Course Correction

For example:

Target

↓

Project

↓

Progress Monitoring

↓

Deviation Detection

↓

Correction

This structure closely resembles modern control theory.

Viewed through the FT perspective, it can also be interpreted as:

Tunnel Construction

↓

Tunnel Monitoring

↓

Tunnel Correction

In other words, civilization governance has long practiced primitive forms of

Function Tunnel control, even without explicitly naming it.

4. The Key Insight: Tunnel Formation Is Feedback

Traditional evaluation methods often focus on final outcomes:

Economic Growth

National Competitiveness

Scientific Leadership

Social Prosperity

However these indicators typically appear long after the underlying structural changes have occurred.

FT-AI introduces a different perspective.

The formation of a Function Tunnel is itself a form of feedback.

For example:

An educational reform may aim to cultivate engineering talent.

Traditional evaluation might wait twenty years and examine economic outcomes.

FT-AI instead asks:

Are new learning pathways emerging?

Are students choosing different trajectories?

Are knowledge-transfer patterns changing?

Are innovation networks expanding?

Are new collaboration tunnels forming?

The emergence of these tunnels provides early evidence about future evolution.

The tunnel itself becomes a measurable signal.

5. Target FT versus Actual FT

A particularly important observation is that systems frequently evolve Function Tunnels different from those originally intended.

Designed FT

≠

Observed FT

Consider a policy intended to stimulate innovation.

Resources may unexpectedly flow toward speculation instead.

A new Function Tunnel has emerged.

The problem is not the absence of a tunnel.

The problem is the emergence of the wrong tunnel.

This distinction is crucial.

FT-AI therefore evaluates not only whether tunnels exist, but whether they align with intended objectives.

This creates a new form of governance metric:

FT Distance

=

Distance(Target FT, Actual FT)

Large deviations become warning signals long before final outcomes appear.

6. Function Tunnel Evolution Cybernetics

These observations suggest a broader framework:

Function Tunnel Evolution Cybernetics (FTEC)

FTEC studies:

- How Function Tunnels emerge
- How Function Tunnels stabilize
- How Function Tunnels expand
- How Function Tunnels drift
- How Function Tunnels collapse
- How Function Tunnels should be corrected

A generic FTEC loop can be represented as:

Goal



Target Function Tunnel



Policy / Project



Observed Function Tunnel



Tunnel Distance Analysis



Correction



Updated Policy

Rather than focusing exclusively on outcomes, FTEC focuses on the dynamics of tunnel formation.

7. Civilization FT-AI as a Governance System

This perspective suggests a different future for FT-AI.

The first generation of Civilization FT-AI may not be a civilization prediction machine.

Instead, it may function as:

FT Detection

FT Measurement

FT Monitoring

FT Governance

FT Correction

Such systems could continuously observe the evolution of societal Function Tunnels and provide actionable guidance long before irreversible failures occur.

In this sense:

Civilization FT-AI

=

Function Tunnel Governance AI

rather than:

Civilization FT-AI

=

Future Prediction Oracle

8. Humanity Already Possesses the Dataset

A second misconception is that civilization-scale learning lacks sufficient training data.

In reality, human history contains an enormous collection of Function Tunnel evolution cases.

Examples include:

- Industrial revolutions
- Educational reforms
- Transportation networks
- Scientific communities

- Innovation ecosystems
- Urbanization processes
- Economic integration systems
- Digital infrastructure expansion

Viewed through the FT lens, these are not isolated historical events. They are records of Function Tunnel emergence, stabilization, and transformation.

Human civilization itself becomes a large-scale FT dataset.

9. Outlook

The first generation of Civilization FT-AI may emerge not from attempting to predict centuries into the future, but from learning to observe and govern Function Tunnel formation in the present.

This shifts the challenge from:

Predict Civilization Destiny

to:

Detect Function Tunnels

Measure Function Tunnels

Monitor Function Tunnels

Correct Function Tunnels

Govern Function Tunnels

The result is a practical path toward civilization-scale intelligence systems.

Rather than waiting centuries for final answers, FT-AI can begin by measuring the tunnels through which civilization is already evolving today.

Closing Remark

The history of civilization can be viewed as the history of Function Tunnel construction.

The future of Civilization FT-AI may therefore be understood as the transition from unconscious tunnel evolution to conscious tunnel governance.

In this sense, Function Tunnel Evolution Cybernetics is not merely a new AI direction.

It is a framework for understanding how civilizations may learn to guide their own long-term evolution.